

D646

Delivering a Communications Strategy

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A regional utility with a new CEO is announcing that storm-hardened power lines will cut outages for 40,000 homes starting in June. The CEO likes to open speeches with the company's history. What should the release's first sentence contain?

- A. The company's founding history.
- B. A quote from the CEO.
- C. Who, what, when, and impact: the utility will begin installing storm-hardened lines in June, cutting outages for 40,000 homes.
- D. The "About the company" boilerplate.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In an inverted-pyramid news release, where does the "About the company" boilerplate go?

- A. At the end
- B. In the first paragraph
- C. Nowhere; releases never include it
- D. In the headline

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A bakery chain with 11 locations has four possible pitches for the local TV station. The marketing lead's favorite color is green. Which is most newsworthy?

- A. It refreshed its logo.
- B. It is hiring 60 local workers this week for a new plant in town.
- C. It was founded in 1985.
- D. It switched to green packaging colors.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A hospital foundation with a glass-roofed atrium wants a donor appeal for its new eye clinic. Which approach uses storytelling best?

- A. List the clinic's procedure counts and equipment.
- B. Follow one farmer who was losing his sight, his surgery at the clinic, and his return to harvest, then make the ask.
- C. Never include any numbers in a story.
- D. Describe the architecture of the atrium.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A software company that just built a podcast studio wants to reuse a 40-minute customer webinar. Which is effective repurposing?

- A. Email the recording link once and stop.
- B. Post the full 40-minute video unchanged on every channel.
- C. Re-record the whole webinar in the podcast studio.
- D. Cut three 45-second captioned clips for social, write a blog summary, and turn a key stat into a graphic.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team pastes the same 1,200-word release text into a LinkedIn post, an Instagram caption, and a short-video script. What is the main problem?

- A. No problem; consistency means identical text everywhere.
- B. Content should only ever go on one channel.
- C. The content wasn't adapted to each channel's format and audience.
- D. The release itself should have been longer.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A craft brewery that sponsors a local softball team pitches a reporter and wins a feature story in a city magazine. What kind of media is the feature?

- A. Earned
- B. Paid, because the brewery sponsors a team.
- C. Owned
- D. Shared

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which is owned media?

- A. Customers reposting the company’s video.
- B. A newspaper story about the company.
- C. The company’s blog and email newsletter.
- D. A sponsored post on a social platform.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A retail chain with 300 stores is changing its store hours next month. Headquarters recently added rooftop solar panels. How should the internal rollout work?

- A. Send one all-staff email with replies turned off.
- B. Announce to the public first, then tell staff.
- C. Pair the news with a feature on the solar panels.
- D. Brief store managers first with talking points and a Q&A channel, then managers tell their teams before the public announcement.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An employee survey shows staff usually learn about company changes from local news before their managers mention them. What does this show?

- A. External audiences should always come first.
- B. Employees don’t read email.
- C. The local news is too slow.
- D. Sequencing is reversed; employees should hear first.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A city parks department with a new website promotes a new trail on radio, social media, and flyers. Radio stresses safety, social stresses fitness, flyers stress cost savings, and none give the opening date. The director jogs daily. What is the best fix?

- A. Lead every channel with the director’s jogging routine.
- B. Set one core message, including the opening date, with supporting points used on every channel.
- C. Add more claims to each channel.
- D. Use only one channel.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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12.

A university’s social media team, whose main account has 80,000 followers, posts videos without captions and images without alt text. Engagement is high. What should change?

- A. Add captions and alt text so people with hearing or vision loss can use the content.
- B. Nothing; high engagement shows it works.
- C. Post only plain text from now on.
- D. Add more hashtags.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A regional utility ~~with a new CEO~~ is announcing that storm-hardened power lines will cut outages for 40,000 homes starting in June. ~~The CEO likes to open speeches with the company's history.~~ What should the release's first sentence contain?

Target word: lead content **Decides:** Inverted pyramid: key facts first.

A	Camouflage	Background isn't news.
B	Adjacent category	Quotes support the lead; they don't replace it.
C	Correct	The most important facts go first.
D	Inverted operation	Boilerplate goes at the end.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

In an inverted-pyramid news release, where does the "About the company" boilerplate go?

Target word: position of boilerplate **Decides:** Least newsworthy content goes last.

A	Correct	Least important content comes last.
B	Inverted operation	The first paragraph holds the key news.
C	Absolute language	Boilerplate is standard at the end.
D	Confusion set	Headlines state the news.

3. Answer B Concept 2

A bakery chain ~~with 11 locations~~ has four possible pitches for the local TV station. ~~The marketing lead's favorite color is green.~~ Which is most newsworthy?

Target word: most newsworthy **Decides:** Timely, local, high impact.

A	Adjacent category	Matters to the company, not viewers.
B	Correct	Timely with clear local impact.
C	Dropped element	Not timely; no news hook.
D	Camouflage	Echoes the irrelevant color detail; low impact.

4. Answer B Concept 3

A hospital foundation ~~with a glass-roofed atrium~~ wants a donor appeal for its new eye clinic. Which approach uses storytelling best?

Target word: best story approach **Decides:** Character, challenge, resolution, then ask.

A	Adjacent category	Facts alone aren't a story.
B	Correct	A character's journey makes the impact concrete.
C	Absolute language	A few numbers can support a story.
D	Camouflage	Not tied to the clinic's impact.

5. Answer D Concept 4

A software company ~~that just built a podcast studio~~ wants to reuse a 40-minute customer webinar. Which is effective repurposing?

Target word: effective repurposing **Decides:** Adapt to each channel's format.

A	Adjacent category	Distribution, not repurposing.
B	Dropped element	Skips adapting to channel formats.
C	Camouflage	Recreates, not repurposes, and ignores channels.
D	Correct	Each piece fits its channel.

6. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

A team pastes the same 1,200-word release text into a LinkedIn post, an Instagram caption, and a short-video script. What is the main problem?

Target word: diagnose poor repurposing **Decides:** Same text regardless of channel.

A	Inverted operation	Consistency is of the message, not the exact words.
B	Absolute language	Multichannel is fine when adapted.
C	Correct	Repurposing means reshaping, not copying.
D	Adjacent category	Length of the source isn't the issue.

7. Answer A Concept 5

A craft brewery ~~that sponsors a local softball team~~ pitches a reporter and wins a feature story in a city magazine. What kind of media is the feature?

Target word: PESO type **Decides:** Won through pitching, not paid.

A	Correct	Coverage gained through media relations.
B	Camouflage	The sponsorship didn't buy this article.
C	Adjacent category	The brewery doesn't control the magazine.
D	Confusion set	Shared is social spreading by others.

8. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

Which is owned media?

Target word: find owned **Decides:** Channels the organization controls.

A	Adjacent category	Shared.
B	Inverted operation	Earned.
C	Correct	It controls both.
D	Confusion set	Paid.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A retail chain ~~with 300 stores~~ is changing its store hours next month. ~~Headquarters recently added rooftop solar panels.~~ How should the internal rollout work?

Target word: internal sequence **Decides:** Staff are directly affected.

A	Dropped element	No two-way channel.
B	Inverted operation	Staff learn from outsiders.
C	Camouflage	Unrelated to the rollout.
D	Correct	Managers cascade, and staff hear it first with a way to ask questions.

10. Answer D Concept 6 • transfer

An employee survey shows staff usually learn about company changes from local news before their managers mention them. What does this show?

Target word: diagnose from the result **Decides:** External is reaching staff before internal.

A	Absolute language	The opposite of good practice.
B	Adjacent category	Managers aren't telling them at all.
C	Inverted operation	The news is actually faster than internal channels.
D	Correct	Internal audiences should not learn from outside sources.

11. Answer B Concept 7

A city parks department ~~with a new website~~ promotes a new trail on radio, social media, and flyers. Radio stresses safety, social stresses fitness, flyers stress cost savings, and none give the opening date. ~~The director jogs daily.~~ What is the best fix?

Target word: fix inconsistency **Decides:** No shared core message.

A	Camouflage	Irrelevant to the trail's message.
B	Correct	Consistency across channels; only the format changes.
C	Inverted operation	Makes the scatter worse.
D	Absolute language	Channels aren't the problem.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A university's social media team, ~~whose main account has 80,000 followers,~~ posts videos without captions and images without alt text. ~~Engagement is high.~~ What should change?

Target word: accessibility fix **Decides:** Missing captions and alt text.

A	Correct	Makes the content accessible, and helps sound-off viewers.
B	Camouflage	Engagement doesn't show who is excluded.
C	Absolute language	Visuals are fine when accessible.
D	Adjacent category	Reach, not accessibility.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	3	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Inverted pyramid	News releases put the most important facts (who, what, when, where, why, impact) first and the boilerplate last.	Opening with history, quotes, or the “About us” paragraph.	What goes in the lead or at the end.
2	Newsworthiness	Stories are newsworthy when timely, local, and high-impact for the outlet’s audience.	Pitching what matters to the company, not to readers.	Choosing among possible pitches.
3	Storytelling	Effective stories follow a character through a challenge to a resolution, then connect to the ask.	Listing facts and calling it a story.	“Tell a story” or donor/customer narrative.
4	Content repurposing	Repurposing adapts one core piece into formats native to each channel.	Posting identical content everywhere.	One long piece to be used across channels.
5	PESO media model	Paid = bought placement; earned = coverage won through pitching; shared = social spread by others; owned = channels the organization controls.	Calling a sponsored post earned or a news story paid.	How the placement was obtained.
6	Internal communication sequencing	Brief managers first with talking points, open two-way channels, and reach employees before the public.	Employees learning news from outside sources.	A change that affects staff.
7	Message consistency	One core message and supporting points stay constant across channels; only the format changes.	Different claims on each channel.	A multichannel campaign with mixed messages.
8	Accessible content	Captions, alt text, and readable contrast make content usable by people with disabilities and by sound-off viewers.	Assuming high engagement means everyone can access it.	Video or images without accessibility features.

Course scope (public description): Delivering a Communications Strategy prepares students to create effective internal and external communications to achieve business objectives. Students will collaborate with peers to develop content for multimedia, press releases, and social media, to successfully implement and deliver a strategic communications plan. Students will create specific messaging for internal communications to build strong corporate cultures, improve workplace communication, and support business needs. Students will also develop external communications for particular goals, purposes, and audiences to ensure content relevancy. This course teaches storytelling techniques and content repurposing to deliver multichannel communications.